

System Admin with IT Service Management and AI Emphasis ServiceNow

Document Information	Details
Document Title	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Affiliation	Dr.umayal ramanthan college for women
College code	ALUUAU29
Address	Alagappa Nagar, Karaikudi, SIVAGANGAI,Tamil Nadu 630003
Department	B.Sc Computer Science
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Authors	Maheshwari Selvaraj M Monika Meenambal gayathri E Mridula K GNagasri Sri

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

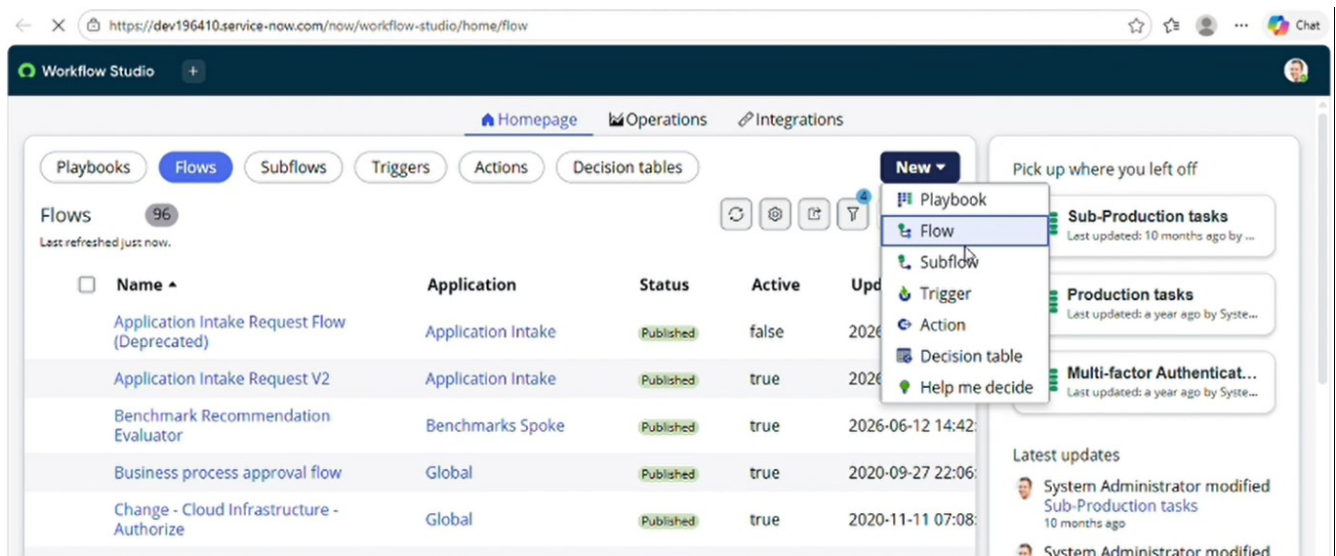
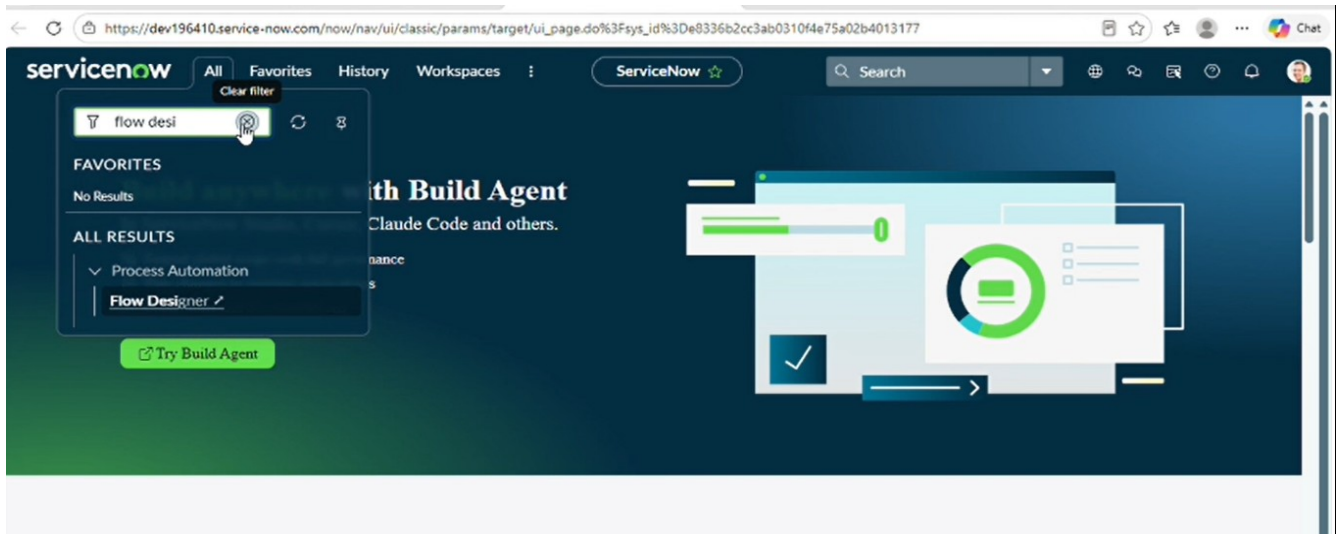
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



Let's get the details for your flow

Flow name * ⓘ

Standard laptop task

Application * ⓘ

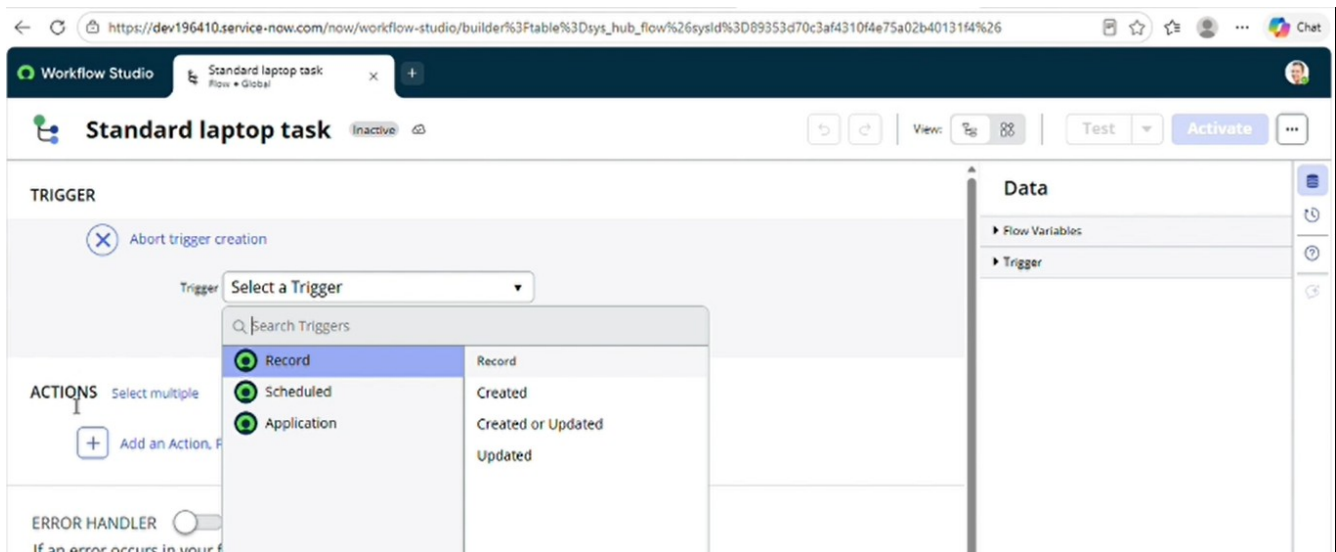
Global

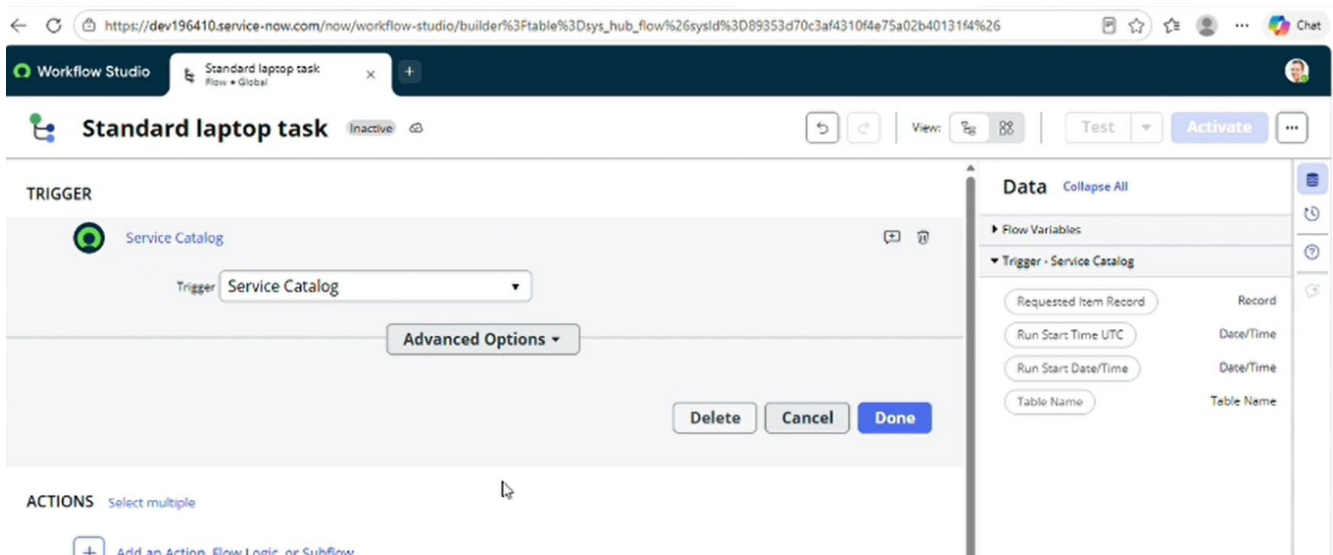
Description ⓘ

Describe your flow.

> Show additional properties

9. Click on Add a trigger
10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.
11. After that click on Done.





12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.

25. Click on save the Flow.

26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

The screenshot shows the 'Standard laptop task' flow in ServiceNow Workflow Studio. The flow is currently 'Inactive'. The 'Action inputs' section is configured with the following details:

- Table Name:** Catalog Task [sc_task]
- * Requested Item [Requested Item]:** Trigger ~> Requested Item ...
- Short Description:** Laptop need to Configured
- Description:** Laptop need to Configured
- Assignment group:** Hardware
- Fields:** Approval (Approved)
- Wait:** ☒
- Template Catalog:** Select Template Catalog Item

The right-hand 'Data' panel shows the following variables:

- Flow Variables:**
- Trigger - Service Catalog:**
- 1 - Create Catalog Task:**

Buttons for 'Test' and 'Activate' are visible in the top right corner.

The screenshot shows the same 'Standard laptop task' flow, but with a confirmation dialog box displayed in the center. The dialog asks: 'Are you sure you want to activate the flow?' and provides the following information:

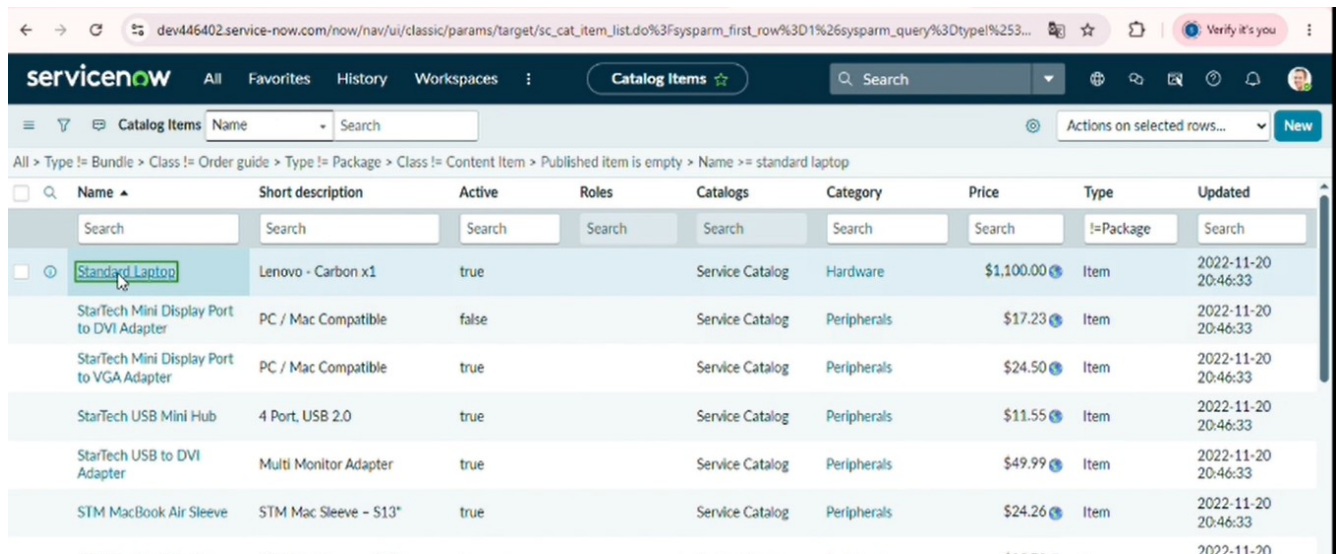
- Text: 'Your flow will start running when the trigger conditions are met.'
- Checkbox: ☐ Don't show me this again
- Buttons: 'Cancel' and 'Activate'

The background interface shows the 'TRIGGER' set to 'Service Catalog' and the 'ACTIONS' list containing '1 - Create Catalog Task'. The 'Activate' button in the top right corner is highlighted.

Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.



The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for the 'Catalog Items' page. The browser address bar indicates the URL: dev446402.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/sc_cat_item_list.do%3Fsysparm_first_row%3D1%26sysparm_query%3Dtype!%253D... The page header includes the ServiceNow logo and navigation tabs: All, Favorites, History, Workspaces, and a 'Catalog Items' button. A search bar is present with the text 'Search'. Below the header, there is a filter bar with the text 'All > Type != Bundle > Class != Order guide > Type != Package > Class != Content Item > Published item is empty > Name >= standard laptop'. The main table displays a list of catalog items with columns: Name, Short description, Active, Roles, Catalogs, Category, Price, Type, and Updated. The first item, 'Standard Laptop', is highlighted with a green box and a mouse cursor. It has a short description of 'Lenovo - Carbon x1', is active, and is categorized as 'Hardware' with a price of '\$1,100.00'. Other items listed include 'StarTech Mini Display Port to DVI Adapter', 'StarTech Mini Display Port to VGA Adapter', 'StarTech USB Mini Hub', 'StarTech USB to DVI Adapter', and 'STM MacBook Air Sleeve'.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbon x1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech Mini Display Port to DVI Adapter	PC / Mac Compatible	false		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$17.23	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech Mini Display Port to VGA Adapter	PC / Mac Compatible	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$24.50	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech USB Mini Hub	4 Port, USB 2.0	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$11.55	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech USB to DVI Adapter	Multi Monitor Adapter	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$49.99	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
STM MacBook Air Sleeve	STM Mac Sleeve - S13"	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$24.26	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

The screenshot shows the 'Catalog Item' form for a 'Standard Laptop'. The form is divided into two main sections. The left section contains fields for 'Name' (Standard Laptop), 'Catalogs' (Service Catalog), 'Category' (Hardware), 'State' (None), 'Checked out' (None), 'Owner', and 'Secondary owners'. The right section contains fields for 'Application' (Global), 'Active' (checked), 'Roles', and 'Fulfillment automation level' (Unspecified). At the bottom, there are tabs for 'Item Details', 'Process Engine', 'Picture', 'Pricing', and 'Portal Settings'.

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.

The screenshot shows the 'Standard Laptop' item view in the Service Catalog. The breadcrumb trail is 'Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop'. The item details for 'Lenovo - Carbon x1' are displayed, including a description and technical specifications. On the right, the 'Order this Item' section shows the price (\$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually), quantity (1), subtotal (\$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually), and delivery time (9 Days). There are buttons for 'Order Now' and 'Add to Cart'. Below this, the 'Shopping Cart' is shown as 'Empty'.

- 5. Now we will see the Order status
- 6. In that click on the Request Number

dev446426.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/com.glideapp.servicelog_checkout_view_v2.do%3Fv%3D1%26sysparm_sys_id%3D5434863c936f03100f76f...

servicenowAllFavoritesHistoryAdminOrder Status: REQ0010002SearchBack to CatalogContinue ShoppingHome

Order Status

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2026-09-22 23:25:03
Request Number: [REQ0010002](#)
Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2026-10-01

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2026-10-01		\$1,100.00 +\$100.00 Annually	1	\$1,100.00 +\$100.00 Annually
				Total	\$1,100.00 +\$100.00 Annually

Back to CatalogContinue ShoppingHome

- 7. It will open the Requested number record.
- 8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

Request - REQ0010001

Short description

Special instructions

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) **Approvers (1)** Recurring Prices (1)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) **Approvers (1)** Recurring Prices (1)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Update Delete

Related Links

Flow Context

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers Group approvals

Number Search Actions on selected rows... New

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

The screenshot shows a ServiceNow Catalog Task form for SCTASK0010001. The form is titled "Catalog Task - SCTASK0010001" and includes a search bar and navigation links (Discuss, Follow, Update, Close Task, Delete). The form fields are organized into two columns. The left column contains: Number (SCTASK0010001), Assigned to (empty), Configuration item (empty), Active (checked), Short description (Laptop need to Configured), Description (Laptop need to Configured), and Comments (Customer visible). The right column contains: Approval (Not Yet Requested), Priority (None), State (Open), Request item (RITM0010002), and Requested for (System Administrator). There are also icons for adding attachments and a "Post" button at the bottom right.

Number	SCTASK0010001	Approval	Not Yet Requested
Assigned to		Priority	None
Configuration item		State	Open
Active	☒	Request item	RITM0010002
Short description	Laptop need to Configured		
Description	Laptop need to Configured		
Comments (Customer visible)	Comments (Customer visible)		

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.